

Daily Bread

A QUEER MAGAZINE FOR THE
OKANAGAN

You found the first issue of a
queer magazine in a city that
keeps telling us it doesn't
have one. Kelowna has queer
history, queer kids, queer
elders, queer bakers and
bureaucrats; what it hasn't had
is paper that says so out loud.

ISSUE №1 • SUMMER 2026

KELOWNA'S COLLAPSE • 48 PP •

PRINT RUN 500

BATCH №1 • FRESH

READ THE ISSUE ↓

SHEET 00 • FRONT
COVER



№1 — RIPOSTE
KELOWNA'S LABORATORIES
COLLAPSE

FREE / PWYC

OUR DAILY DREAD

S **I.** You found the first issue of a queer magazine in a city that keeps telling us it doesn't have one. Kelowna has queer history, queer kids, queer elders, queer bakers and bureaucrats; what it hasn't had is paper that says so out loud.

This issue is about collapse: the orchards, the venues, the rent math, the bridge traffic. Not because we're doomers, but because things fall apart here on schedule, and naming the schedule is the first act of repair.

Rip out the poster. Colour the cartoon. Mail us your

CONTINUED ON SHEET 34 →

— the editors ✕

MASTHEAD / №1 • SUMMER DB-
2026 000

EDITOR your name here

ART + COMICS open call

YOUNG VOICES three writers,
DESK 17-24

PRINTED unceded syilx
ON territory

Daily Bread is published on the unceded, ancestral territory of the syilx Okanagan people. We pay rent to a landlord and respect to a Nation, and we know only one of those is owed.



FUNDED BY RIPOSTE
LABORATORIES INC.



RIPOSTE LABORATORIES INC.

Daily Bread is baked quarterly in Kelowna, BC. Free where you found it. Pay what you can where you can't.



ISSN PENDING
№1 • SUMMER 2026

see you at the thaw ✕

PRINTED ON UNCEDED SYILX OKANAGAN TERRITORY IN A RUN OF 500. SET
IN IBM PLEX MONO AND UNIFRAKTRUMAGUNTIA. ERRORS ARE OURS;
CORRECTIONS ARE YOURS; THE LEFTOVER INK WENT INTO THE STICKERS.
• PARRY. RIPOSTE.

OUR DAILY DREAD

fury and your recipes. This crumbs on it.
thing only works if you get

CONTENTS.

Twelve contributors made №1: writers aged 17-74, two photographers, one cartoonist, one very patient proofreader.

Every byline is local. Every fee got paid before the printer did.

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A RUDE HISTORY

The valley sold itself twice: first as Eden, then as equity. Fruit ranchers went broke so often the packinghouses printed their own scrip; when fruit died, the pitch became retirement sun; when the retirees priced out the pickers, the pitch became lakeside lofts. Each act ended the same way, with the people who did the work living further from the water.

The queer history is braided through all of it: dance halls with unofficial nights, friendship networks that doubled as housing lists, a scene that survived by being useful and quiet until it didn't have to be.

"quiet until it didn't have to be" — put on a shirt

LEDGER / WHAT COLLAPSED WHEN

ENTRY		STATUS
1913	fruit prices crater; scrip economy begins	BUST
1930s	packinghouse layoffs, valley-wide	BUST
1958	bridge opens; ferry workers obsolete overnight	PIVOT
1973	ALR freezes orchard speculation (briefly)	PARRY
1980s	sawmill era ends; wine era begins	PIVOT
2003	firestorm; 239 homes, 30k evacuated	BURN
2017	flood year; the lake takes the boardwalk	FLOOD
2021	heat dome; hottest place in Canada, again	BURN
2024	last dedicated queer venue closes	BUST

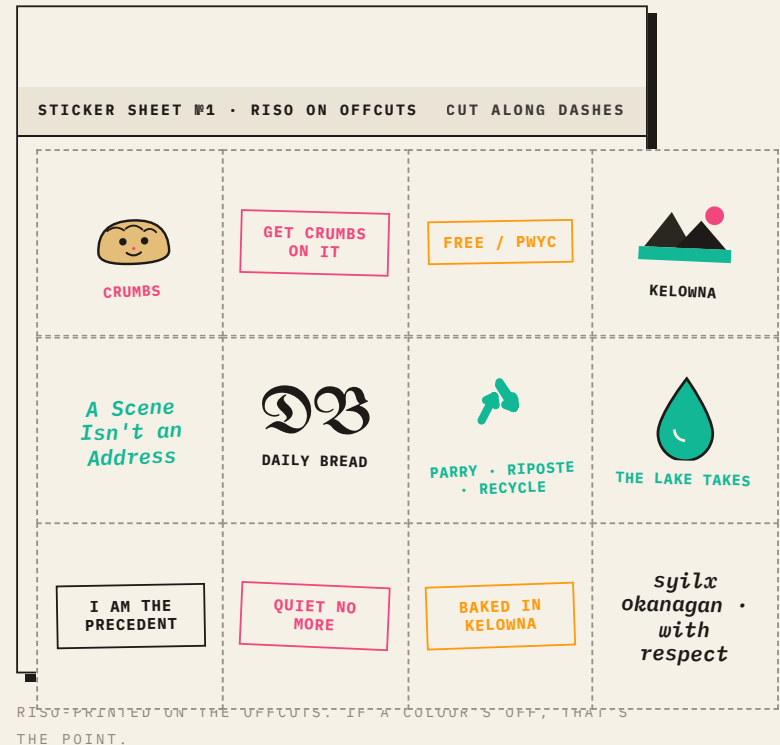
// peel me · sticker sheet · the leftover ink went here

PEEL ME.

The leftover ink went here. Print the page, cut along the dashes, and put the valley on your water bottle. Twelve stickers; no two collapses alike.

PRINT THIS SHEET

OR PRESS CTRL / ⌘ + P · CUT
ALONG THE DASHED LINES





LABORATORIES INC.

FROM THE LAB

Full disclosure, printed large: this magazine is funded by Riposte Laboratories, a Kelowna outfit that counter-attacks waste with recycled-plastic injection molding and reclaimed-cell modular power. We share what we're building here, in the same pages, at the same volume as everyone else.

The deal, in writing: the Lab pays the printer and gets two pages. The editors answer to readers, not the funder. If that ever changes, the colouring page will let you know.

FUNDER DISCLOSURE • SIGNED

parry. riposte. recycle.

THIS QUARTER / STATUS BOARD

Q3 • 2026

REV. A

Plastic Works — molds v2, park benches from #5 tubs **LIVE**

Project HEX — reclaimed-cell grading rig **WIP**

Esh — shop assistant, currently a whiteboard **DRAWING**

Daily Bread №2 — theme vote **OPEN**

First Friday open doors — bring clean plastics **RECURRING**

WHY FUND A MAGAZINE?

Because a lab that fixes material waste in a town losing its cultural material would be doing half a job. Paper is infrastructure. So are drag nights. Line item approved.

TOUR THE SHOP: OPEN DOORS FIRST FRIDAYS • BRING CLEAN #2 + #5 PLASTICS.

this magazine. your move, city.

RIPOSTE

METHOD — COMPILED FROM CITY ARCHIVES, NEWSPAPER MORGUES, AND ELDERS WHO WERE THERE. CORRECTIONS WELCOME AND EXPECTED.

ARCHIVAL PHOTO — 1958 FLOATING
BRIDGE OPENING DAY

FIG. 1 — THE FLOATING BRIDGE, 1958. TRAFFIC ARRIVED; THE FERRY DIED THE SAME DAY.

Every boom since has made the same promise, and every bust has been treated as a surprise. Fruit prices collapsed. Sawmills closed. The 2003 firestorm ate 239 homes while the city watched from the beach.

This issue asks the impolite question: what if collapse isn't the exception here — what if it's the business model? The ledger has the receipts.

ARCHIVAL PHOTO — ORCHARD CREWS,
1910S

FIG. 2 — PICKING CREWS, RUTLAND BENCHES. THE APPLES WERE A PYRAMID SCHEME WITH ROOTS.

Sec.02 // photo essay · Bernard Ave, 6am

VACANCY

Six storefronts, one morning,
zero people. A walking tour of
what the “best downtown in

Canada” looks like before the
patios open – and after the
leases triple.

PHOTO — PAPERED-OVER STOREFRONT WINDOW

FIG. 3 — “FOR LEASE / GREAT EXPOSURE.” THE EXPOSURE IS DOING A LOT OF WORK.

Sec.19 // submissions · #2 — “the thaw”

GET CRUMBS ON IT.

Serialized fiction, an open
centrefold, a young-voices
desk, a directory that stays
current: #1 is a first draft of
a scene arguing it exists. #2
is “The Thaw” — what comes
back. Send us your fury and
your recipes.

HELLO@DAILYBREAD.EXAMPLE

DEADLINE · SEPT 15

send poems. weird welcome.

WHAT WE TAKE

► **Art for the centrefold** —
A4 landscape, 300dpi, any
medium. We pay; rights stay
yours.

► **Opinion (under 25)** — 500
words of correct anger.

► **Poems & fiction** — we read
everything twice.

► **Comics** — pitch us six
panels for the guest slot.

► **Listings & corrections** —
free, always.

VOTE — #2 THEME

☐ The Thaw (what comes
back)

☐ Water Rights & Wrongs

☐ Night Shift (who runs 2AM
Kelowna)

MARK ONE · PHOTOGRAPH · SEND.
DEMOCRACY.

Sec.19

// correspondence · write to us

Crumbs Mail

READER CORRESPONDENCE · 100 EDITION

This box is empty because you haven't written yet. First issue problems. Fill it with fury, recipes, corrections, crushes (anonymized), and photos of the colouring page done wrong on purpose.

TIP JAR + SUBMISSIONS

SCAN, OR WRITE TO THE ADDRESS ON THE
SUBMIT PAGE

PHOTO — EMPTY INTERIOR, CORDS ON FLOOR

PHOTO — SUN-BLEACHED MANNEQUIN

FIGS. 4-5 — SHOT ON EXPIRED FILM, APPROPRIATELY.

PHOTO — FOURTH FRAME

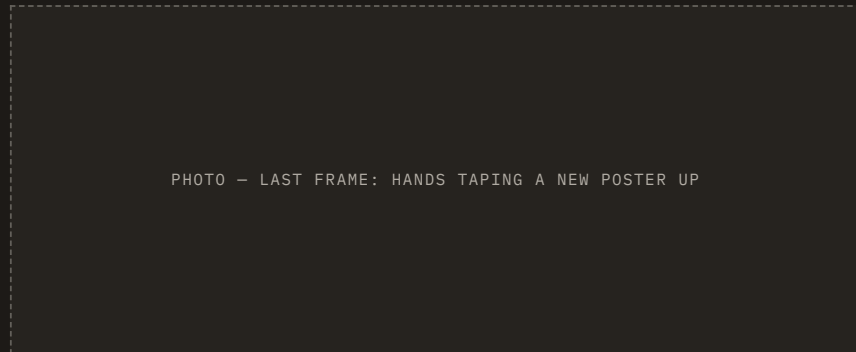


PHOTO — LAST FRAME: HANDS TAPING A NEW POSTER UP

FIG. 6 — SOMEBODY ALWAYS TAPES SOMETHING UP. THAT'S THE WHOLE THESIS.

Vacancy isn't emptiness — it's
a waiting room. Every papered
window downtown is a bet

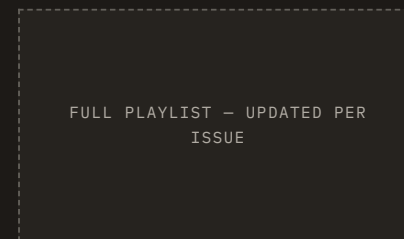
someone rich made against
someone broke. The essay ends
where the bets get called.

Sec.16

// listening · loud in the paste-up room

WHAT WE'RE LISTENING TO

Rotation



FULL PLAYLIST — UPDATED PER
ISSUE

SEND US ONE SONG + ONE SENTENCE

STAFF ROTATION / #1

LOUD

"Bench Water" THE CONNECTOR, AT NIGHT
— local
EP

ballroom sets — PRE-SCREENING HOMEWORK
Paris Is Burning
warm-ups

snotty coast PASTE-UP FUEL
punk — 7" from
a Rutland
garage

a syilx ASK AT THE RECORD STALL
songwriter's
live tape

disco AUG 15, BRING SPEAKERS
edits
for the
beach
assembly

the FIELD RECORDING, HONESTLY
diner
jukebox,
booth
six

whatever UNRELEASED. PROTECTED.
the
night
cook
hums

Sec.15 // food · no free meals, no mercy

The Bite Back

RESTAURANT CRITIQUE · NO FREE MEALS, NO MERCY

WINE BAR ·
LAKESHORE · \$\$\$\$

2/5 –
GORGEOUS,
HUNGRY

THE PLACE THAT REPLACED THE DINER

The room is stunning, the playlist is a moodboard, and the “heritage tomato moment” is one tomato. Our server was the best actor in the valley: she said “great choice” about a \$19 plate of air with total conviction. We left elegant and starving, then bought gas-station taquitos. Verdict: it photographs like a meal.

HOUSE RULES

we pay full price · we book under fake names · patios judged by dog traffic · anywhere that feeds evacuation crews gets a permanent star

DINER · 5/5 – PROTECT AT
RUTLAND · \$ ALL COSTS

THE 24-HOUR SURVIVOR ON HWY 33

Coffee refills arrive before you ask, the hashbrowns have structural integrity, and the night cook remembers your order and your pronouns. Every collapse in this issue is survivable from booth six. Bring cash, tip like rent is due, because theirs is too.

Sec.03 // young voices desk · unreviewed. unedited. correct.

YOUNG VOICES

Three field reports from writers who can't vote yet but can already do the rent math. We paid them; we didn't touch a word.

REPORT 01

AGE 19 · HOUSING

NOBODY MY AGE CAN AFFORD TO STAY

I work two jobs and split a two-bedroom with three people, and I'm the success story. My group chat is a slow-motion goodbye party: Vernon, Calgary, mom's basement in Surrey.

"Every viewing is forty people deep and one of them is always crying."

Sec.03 // young voices desk · unreviewed. unedited. correct.

REPORT 02

AGE 22 · COMING OUT

OUT AT THE PACKINGHOUSE

I came out at a bush party in Glenmore and the worst thing that happened was a guy named Tyler said "cool" and asked if I could drive him home. Not paradise, not hell, just a small city learning faster than its city council.

geography is the last closet

Sec.13 // reviews · field-tested

REVIEWS / FIELD-TESTED

ENDURED · 3/5

DRAG NIGHT · POP-UP

RIPS

"HARVEST MOON" AT THE COMMUNITY HALL

A gymnasium, a rented fog machine, and the best crowd this valley has produced. The floor is lava and the lava is love. Next one: see calendar.

BAKERY · DOWNTOWN

4/5

THE NEW SOURDOUGH PLACE ON ELLIS

The loaf is honest, the queue is chatty, and the owner slips day-olds to anyone who compliments the playlist. Crumb declined to comment, citing family.

CIVIC · ONGOING

0/5

COUNCIL PUBLIC-HEARING LIVESTREAM

Buffering as dramaturgy. Runtime: eternal. One star added for the councillor who said "housing is for people" out loud; four removed for the vote after.

WANT A REVIEW? WE COVER ANYTHING QUEER-ADJACENT AND OKANAGAN-MADE: SHOWS, MENUS, ZINES, HOT SAUCE, CITY COUNCIL MEETINGS (AS PERFORMANCE ART). THE ONLY CRITERION IS THAT WE CAN ATTEND, TASTE, OR ENDURE IT IN PERSON.

Sec.12

// advice · certified since Tuesday

Use a Local Guy

CERTIFIED · SINCE TUESDAY

**My parents keep introducing me as their “roommate's friend.”
The roommate is my wife. Escalate or let it ride?**

— TIRED IN LAKE COUNTRY

Send them a fridge magnet of your wedding photo every month. No note. Bureaucracy respects witnesses and parents respect fridges. By magnet six you'll be “the girls.” By ten, they're paying for brunch.

Is it a red flag if a date says Kelowna has “no culture”?

— DEFENSIVE DOWNTOWN

It's a beige flag. Hand them this magazine, the calendar page, and a pen. If they come to one thing on the calendar, marry them. If they critique the font, you've met the editor — run.

Sec.03

// young voices desk · unreviewed. unedited. correct.

REPORT 03

AGE 17 · FIRE SEASON

I'VE EVACUATED TWICE AND I CAN'T VOTE YET

My childhood photos are sorted by smoke year. We packed the car in 2021 and again in 2023, and both times the adults on the radio called it unprecedented. It has precedent.

"I am the precedent."

THE WAITLIST

Trying to find queer-competent healthcare in the Central Okanagan is a part-time job with no benefits. We phoned every clinic so you don't have to; everyone we reached described the same triangle of phone tag, referral limbo, and a highway.

14

MONTHS
• AVG
GENDER
CLINIC
WAIT

2

PROVIDERS
TAKING
NEW
PATIENTS

400

KM TO THE
NEAREST
ALTERNATIVE

Two evacuations in five years says keep it packed, not planned. Know your route out, your meeting spot, and one person out of town who takes the check-in calls. The writer in Young Voices shouldn't know this list better than city council does.

THE GO-BAG / FIRE SEASON CHECKLIST

- ☐ Water – 4L per person, rotate it
- ☐ Meds + a photographed prescription list
- ☐ Documents in a freezer bag (ID, insurance, lease – ha)
- ☐ Chargers, battery bank, cash in small bills
- ☐ N95s from the smoke drawer. You have a smoke drawer
- ☐ The pets. Count them twice. Then the neighbour's
- ☐ This magazine – morale is supplies

Sec.18 // mutual aid · keep this page · verified quarterly

KEEP THIS PAGE / DIRECTORY

VERIFIED QUARTERLY · TEAR OUT
OK

Crisis line (24/7, trans-competent) placeholder – verify before pr

Informed-consent clinic list updated quarterly · this page

Youth drop-in (14-24) wed + sat · downtown
°

Mutual aid pantry rutland · no questions

Legal aid – tenant defence first mondays · library

Elder queer social (55+) thursdays · lakeshore
°

Sober hangs see calendar, marked °

A RESOURCE MISSING? WRONG NUMBER?
TELL US – THIS PAGE IS THE WHOLE
POINT.

WHAT ACTUALLY HELPS /
CHECKLIST

FIELD-TESTED

- ☐ The informed-consent clinic list – updated quarterly

- ☐ Pharmacists can renew more than you think – ask directly

- ☐ Telehealth counts. Bad wifi is still shorter than 400 km

- ☐ Bring a friend to appointments. Bureaucracy respects witnesses

shout out Deb, seriously

HEARD ON BERNARD / VERBATIM

“My GP is great. My GP is also in Vancouver, where I don't live.”

“The pharmacist figured it out before any doctor did. Shout out Deb.”

“I got my referral the same month my lease ended. Guess which one moved faster.”

“Honestly? The group chat is the healthcare system.”

FOUR OF ELEVEN INTERVIEWS · ALL ANONYMIZED · METHODOLOGY: SEE DIRECTORY

Sec.05

// interview · forty years of nerve

*"We didn't have a bar,
darling. We had basements,
and we had nerve."*

MISS DEMEANOUR · PERFORMING IN THE OKANAGAN SINCE 1986

"The audience got younger and the rent got meaner. In '86 the danger was people; now the danger is landlords. Where did everyone go when the venues closed? Nowhere, sweetheart;

ARCHIVED · SHOEBOX FONDS

MD, continued: People ask if I'm bitter about the decades in basements. Bitter? Those basements had better sound systems than half the clubs I've played since. We recorded everything on cassette. Someone's nephew digitized it all last winter and I cried

that's the secret. We're all still here, we just meet in gymnasiums and orchards and each other's kitchens. A scene isn't an address."

for a week. That's your history project right there – a drag queen's shoebox. The city archive called ME. I said darling, you're forty years late and you're paying for the shelving. They did. Progress is slow, then it's sudden, then it sends an invoice.

Sec.17

// film · classics, outdoors

MOVIES IN THE PARK / HOSTED BY DAILY BREAD

The Rewind

CRITERION-SHELF DEEP CUTS

Old films, screened like they matter – because a town with no rep cinema deserves one anyway. Each issue: three from the queer canon, then we show them outside. Program notes below; lawn chairs on the calendar.

BRING – A BLANKET · BUG SPRAY · SOMEONE YOU'RE NERVOUS AROUND · A THERMOS (WE SELL NONE OF THESE ON PURPOSE)

#1 PROGRAM / 35MM ENERGY,
NOTES DIGITAL BUDGET

Paris Is Burning (1990) – The ballroom documentary that gave the culture its vocabulary. Watch it with people; the applause is part of the text.

My Own Private Idaho (1991) – River Phoenix falls asleep on every road in the Northwest. The campfire scene alone is worth the mosquitoes.

The Watermelon Woman (1996) – Cheryl Dunye invents an archive because nobody kept one for her. Relevant to a magazine doing the same thing.

East Kelowna benches – history
underfoot

Oct 03 **Cassette night: the
Shoebox Fonds**

venue TBA – Miss
Demeanour presiding

Oct 17 **Issue №2 launch +
colouring contest**

location in №2.
obviously

**MOVIES IN THE PARK / HOSTED BY
DAILY BREAD**

**SUMMER SLATE / RAIN MOVES US
AT DUSK TO THE LAB**

Aug 14 **Paris Is Burning
(1990)**

City Park, at dusk

Sep 04 **My Own Private
Idaho (1991)**

Ben Lee Park, at dusk

Sep 25 **The Watermelon
Woman (1996)**

Rutland Centennial
Park, at dusk

FREE / PWYC • CAPTIONS ON •
PROJECTOR + POWER: RECLAIMED
CELLS, PROJECT HEX

VOTE – OCTOBER SCREENING

☐ Portrait of a Lady on
Fire (2019)

☐ Hedwig and the Angry Inch
(2001)

☐ Bound (1996)

MARK ONE • PHOTOGRAPH • SEND.
FILM DEMOCRACY.

Sec.06 // poetry • submissions • lit

Late Effect

the ogopogo is real and she is tired
of being your tourism budget
she surfaces only for girls
who skip stones left-handed
and boys who came out in a parking lot
she keeps every ring ever thrown in.

– SUBMITTED FROM RUTLAND, AGE 20

Harvest

my grandmother thinned apples so the rest grow large
i learned it as economics
she meant it as mercy
this town keeps thinning people
and calling the fruit a miracle.

– SUBMITTED FROM EAST KELOWNA, AGE 24

Sec.08 // crumbs · ep.1 · a golem seeks housing

CRUMBS.

Our guest strip. Six panels, one loaf, zero vacancies. The slot is open, it pays, and the only brief is: make us laugh about the thing that isn't funny.

EP.1 · PENCILS, INK & CRUMBS BY OPEN CALL



TO BE CONTINUED IN #2 - "THE THAW." WANT THE GUEST SLOT? SIX PANELS TO HELLO@DAILYBREAD.EXAMPLE.

Sec.14 // the calendar · aug-oct 2026 · clip + fridge

THE CALENDAR.

Listings are free; email by the 15th. Sober and all-ages options marked °.

AUG - OCT 2026		CLIP + FRIDGE
Aug 07	First Friday at the Lab °	Riposte shop floor – tours, benches, zines
Aug 14	Movies in the Park #1 °	City Park – Paris Is Burning
Aug 15	Queer Beach Assembly °	Gyro Beach, north end – bring shade to share
Aug 22	Harvest Moon drag night	community hall – PWYC at the door
Sep 05	Zine-making + submission clinic °	library makerspace – bring your fury
Sep 15	#2 submission deadline	art, opinion, poems
Sep 19	Orchard walk with an elder °	

Sec.11 // fiction · serialized

SHORT FICTION

THE LAKE TAKES

BY [AUTHOR] · ILLUSTRATION OPEN CALL

The realtor said the house had lake access, and it did, the way a mouth has throat access. June found the stairs behind the lilac on the second day – forty-one steps of split cedar going down to a dock that wasn't in the listing photos, because docks that old don't photograph, they testify.

Her grandmother had warned her about the lake in the language June only half-kept: it gives, but it keeps receipts. Every family on the bench had a story with the same shape – a ring, a brother, a hayfork, a name – something the water accepted

and never gave back at the same size.

On the dock she found the offerings the winter had rearranged: a doll's shoe, a fishing licence from 1974, a phone in a sandwich bag, screen up, one notification still glowing like a lure. The lake was flat as a ledger. June, who had moved back for the cheap rent that no longer existed and the family that barely did, rolled her jeans and stepped down onto the first cold plank.

“Okay,” she told the water, the town, the whole arranged marriage of valley and debt. “Show me what you kept.”

CONTINUED IN #2 – “THE THAW”

Serialized fiction runs across issues. Miss one and the lake keeps your bookmark.

GUEST STRIP / ROTATING SLOT

FULL-PAGE GUEST COMIC – A DIFFERENT LOCAL CARTOONIST EVERY ISSUE. #1
GUEST: [NAME], “PARALLEL PARKING AS QUEER PRAXIS”

Sec.11

// the wall · rip-out centrefold · pull gently

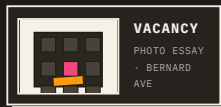
THE WALL

The centrefold is a poster. Tear it out along the gutter and put it where a landlord can see it. This issue's wall belongs to the scene that refuses to be an address.

yes — actually rip it



ALSO ON THE WALLS /
PLATE ROOM



COLOURING PAGE · PULL
OUT

COLOUR YOUR OWN COLLAPSE



The line-art page is yours. Crayon the orchard, redline the rent, sign the bottom. Photograph it and send it back; the best one runs the wall in #2.

Sec.08

// satire · crayon-proof paper

COLOUR YOUR OWN COLLAPSE

#1

LINE-ART SATIRE CARTOON, COMMISSIONED PER ISSUE. #1: CITY COUNCIL, DRAWN AS CHEERFUL REALTORS, RIDE A SADDLED OGOPOGO ACROSS THE LAKE WHILE TOWING THE LAST QUEER VENUE ON A "LUXURY LOFTS" BARGE. PURE OUTLINES · NO FILLS · CRAYON-PROOF PAPER.

FIG. 8 — AISLIN-GRADE DISRESPECT, LOCAL EDITION

TEST YOUR CRAYONS:    

TAG US WITH YOUR FINISHED PAGE